

GovCon BD Upskilling Program

AI for GovCon BD

Module 5.1 (Bonus) | All Domains (Efficiency)

DURATION

2-2.5 hours

FORMAT

Live Instructor-Led

GovConGiants

30-Day Foundation Program

Module 5.1: AI for GovCon BD (Bonus Module)

Learning Objectives

By the end of this module, learners will be able to:

- 1. **Select** the right AI tool for different GovCon tasks
- 2. **Write** effective prompts that produce useful outputs
- 3. **Apply** AI across the BD lifecycle (research, capture, proposals)
- 4. **Verify** AI outputs against authoritative sources
- 5. **Build** a personal library of reusable GovCon prompts

Why AI Matters for GovCon

The Efficiency Multiplier

AI tools can dramatically accelerate GovCon BD work:

Summarize 50-page RFP	2-3 hours	15-30 minutes	80%+
Research agency spending	1-2 hours	20-30 minutes	70%+
Draft past performance narrative	2-3 hours	30-45 minutes	75%+
Analyze competitor portfolio	1-2 hours	15-30 minutes	75%+
Create compliance matrix (initial)	2-4 hours	30-60 minutes	70%+

The Reality Check

AI is powerful but has limits:

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Summarizing large documents	Accessing real-time data
Drafting content for human review	Making strategic decisions
Analyzing patterns in data you provide	Verifying facts independently
Explaining complex topics	Knowing your specific company
Brainstorming options	Understanding customer relationships
Structuring information	Replacing human judgment

The Rule

AI is your research assistant, not your decision-maker. Always verify, always review, always apply human judgment.

Lesson Content

1. Choosing the Right AI Tool

Several AI tools work well for GovCon work:

ChatGPT	General purpose, widely known	Most tasks, good starting point	Free/Paid
Claude	Long documents, nuanced analysis	RFP analysis, complex writing	Free/Paid
Gemini	Google integration, research	Web research, current info	Free/Paid
Copilot	Microsoft integration	Excel analysis, Word docs	Microsoft 365

Recommendation: Start with one tool, learn it well, then expand. All major AI tools handle GovCon tasks effectively.

2. The Anatomy of a Good Prompt

Effective prompts have consistent structure:

The CRAFT Framework:

Context	Background information	"I'm a BD analyst at a small IT services company..."
Role	Who AI should act as	"Act as an experienced capture manager..."
Action	What you want done	"Analyze this RFP and identify all requirements..."
Format	How to structure output	"Provide as a numbered list with..."
Tone	Style of response	"Use professional, concise language..."

Example Prompt Using CRAFT:

Context: I'm preparing for a capture kickoff meeting for a VA IT modernization opportunity worth \$15M.

Role: Act as an experienced capture manager who has won similar VA contracts.

Action: Help me create a capture kickoff agenda that identifies the key questions we need to answer, initial win themes to test, and first 30-day milestones.

Format: Provide as a structured agenda with timing for a 2-hour meeting, followed by a bulleted action item list.

Tone: Professional and direct, suitable for a senior audience.

3. Let AI Write Your Prompts

One of the most powerful techniques: **ask AI to create prompts for you.**

The Meta-Prompt Approach:

Instead of struggling to write the perfect prompt, describe what you need and ask AI to generate the prompt:

PROMPT: Create a Prompt for Me

I need to [DESCRIBE YOUR TASK].

My situation:

- [RELEVANT CONTEXT]
- [CONSTRAINTS OR REQUIREMENTS]
- [DESIRED OUTPUT FORMAT]

Create a detailed, effective prompt I can use to accomplish this.
Include placeholders for information I'll need to fill in.

Example:

I need to analyze RFPs and extract all the evaluation criteria so I can build a compliance matrix.

My situation:

- I work at a small IT services company
- I typically review RFPs for IT modernization contracts
- I need the output in a table format I can paste into Excel

Create a detailed, effective prompt I can use to accomplish this.
Include placeholders for information I'll need to fill in.

AI will generate a ready-to-use prompt with proper structure, placeholders, and formatting instructions.

Why This Works:

- AI understands prompt best practices
- Saves time crafting complex prompts
- Produces more consistent results
- Easy to iterate: “Make this prompt more specific about...”

Pro Tip

When you find a prompt that works well, ask AI: “How could I improve this prompt to get even better results?” AI can critique and enhance its own prompts.

4. Prompt Engineering Best Practices

Do This:

Be specific	“VA IT services” beats “government work”
Provide examples	“Format like this example...”
Set constraints	“In 200 words or less...”
Ask for structure	“Provide as a table with columns for...”
Request reasoning	“Explain your analysis...”
Iterate	“Now refine this to emphasize...”

Avoid This:

Vague requests	Add specifics about what you need
Single long prompt	Break into steps, iterate
Accepting first output	Ask for refinements
No context	Explain your situation
Asking for opinions	Ask for analysis with criteria

5. AI for Each BD Phase

Market Research & Intelligence

PROMPT: Agency Research Summary

I need to research [AGENCY NAME] as a potential target for our [SERVICE TYPE] offerings.

Using general knowledge about federal agencies, provide:

1. Agency mission overview (2-3 sentences)
2. Major components/bureaus
3. Typical procurement priorities for agencies like this
4. Key initiatives or modernization efforts to research
5. Suggested data to pull from USAspending and SAM.gov Contract Data

6. Questions I should answer about this agency

Note: I'll verify all specific data against official sources.

Opportunity Discovery & Qualification

PROMPT: Opportunity Summary

Summarize this SAM.gov opportunity for a quick team review:

[PASTE FULL OPPORTUNITY TEXT]

Provide:

1. Executive summary (3 sentences)
2. Key requirements (bullets)
3. Deadlines and timeline
4. Set-aside and eligibility
5. Initial assessment: Is this worth pursuing for a company that provides [YOUR SERVICES]?

Capture & Competitive Positioning

PROMPT: Win Theme Development

Develop win themes for this opportunity:

Opportunity: [DESCRIPTION]

Customer Pain Points: [IF KNOWN]

Our Strengths: [LIST]

Competitor Likely Strengths: [LIST]

Create 3-5 win themes using format:

"Because of [capability], we deliver [benefit] that [addresses priority], proven by [evidence]."

Make them specific, provable, and differentiating.

Proposal Support

PROMPT: RFP Requirements Extraction

Extract all requirements from this RFP section:

[PASTE SECTION L OR C]

Format as a compliance matrix with:

- RFP Reference
- Requirement Description
- Type (Shall/Should/May)
- Notes on compliance approach

Flag any ambiguous requirements or questions to ask.

6. The AI Workflow for GovCon

Step-by-Step Process:

1. **GATHER:** Collect raw information (RFP, SAM.gov contract data, opportunity)
2. **PROMPT:** Ask AI to analyze, summarize, or draft
3. **REVIEW:** Read AI output critically
4. **VERIFY:** Check facts against authoritative sources
5. **REFINE:** Ask AI to improve based on your feedback
6. **CUSTOMIZE:** Add your knowledge, relationships, strategy
7. **FINALIZE:** Human makes final decisions and edits

Key Checkpoints:

After PROMPT	Check if output is on-target
After REVIEW	Identify gaps, errors, or weak areas
After VERIFY	Confirm all facts against sources
After REFINE	Ensure it reflects your actual strategy
FINALIZE	Add expert judgment, relationship context

7. AI Ethics and Security

What NOT to Share with AI:

Proprietary pricing	Competitive sensitivity
Source selection info	Procurement integrity
Customer PII	Privacy regulations
Classified information	Security requirements
Trade secrets	Competitive protection
Internal win strategies	Competitive sensitivity

Safe Practices:

- Use general terms when possible (“a federal agency” vs. specific names)
- Sanitize data before pasting (remove PII, sensitive details)
- Use enterprise versions of AI tools when available
- Follow your company’s AI usage policy
- When in doubt, don’t share it

8. Building Your Prompt Library

Create a personal collection of prompts organized by task:

Recommended Categories:

1. **Market Research:** Agency overview, contract data analysis, competitor research
2. **Opportunity Discovery:** Opportunity summary, qualification assessment, RFI analysis
3. **Customer Engagement:** Meeting prep, elevator pitch, follow-up emails
4. **Capture:** Win themes, discriminators, competitive analysis, teaming outreach
5. **Proposal:** Requirements extraction, compliance matrix, section drafting, past performance
6. **Operations:** FAR explanation, capability statements, metrics analysis

■ Applied Exercise: Build Your AI Prompt Library

Scenario: Create a personal prompt library you can use in your daily work.

Part 1: Test Core Prompts

1. Open your preferred AI tool (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini)
2. Test at least one prompt from each category: Market research, Opportunity analysis, Win theme development, Proposal support
3. Document what worked and what needed adjustment

Part 2: Customize for Your Work

1. Identify 3-5 tasks you do frequently
2. Create or customize prompts for each
3. Test each prompt with real or sample data
4. Refine until you get useful outputs

Part 3: Document Your Library

Use the Work Artifact template to create your prompt library.

Time: 30-45 minutes

Work Artifact: Personal AI Prompt Library

Header

Your Name: _____

Date: _____

AI Tool(s) Used: _____

Prompt Template

For each prompt, document:

Prompt Name	
Category	Research / Opportunity / Capture / Proposal / Other
Use When	
The Prompt	
What It Produces	
Verification Needed	

(Create 5 prompts minimum)

Lessons Learned

What **worked** **well:**

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What **needed** **refinement:**

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Knowledge Check (Self-Assessment)

Question 1 (Application)

You need to summarize a 75-page RFP for your team. What's the best AI approach?

- A) Paste the entire document and ask for a summary
- B) **Break into sections, summarize each, then synthesize**
- C) Ask AI to find the RFP online and summarize it
- D) AI can't handle documents that long

Correct Answer: B

Question 2 (Recall)

What does the "C" in the CRAFT prompt framework stand for?

- A) Clarity
- B) **Context**
- C) Command
- D) Constraint

Correct Answer: B

Question 3 (Application)

You're using AI to draft a past performance narrative. What should you do after AI generates the draft?

- A) Submit it directly to the proposal
- B) **Verify facts, add your expertise, and refine**
- C) Ask AI to verify its own work

D) Nothing—AI output is ready to use

Correct Answer: B

Question 4 (Ethics)

Which of the following is safe to share with AI tools?

- A) Your company's proprietary pricing strategy
- B) **A sanitized summary of an agency's public spending data**
- C) Source selection information from a customer
- D) Customer personal information from your CRM

Correct Answer: B

Question 5 (Application)

Your AI-generated win theme says "We have extensive federal experience." How should you improve it?

- A) It's fine—clear and professional
- B) **Ask AI to add specific proof points and quantify**
- C) Remove it—AI shouldn't write win themes
- D) Add more adjectives to make it stronger

Correct Answer: B

Manager Discussion Prompts

1. **Current Context:** "Does our company have policies or guidelines for using AI tools? Are there approved tools I should use?"
2. **Application:** "Where could AI help me be more efficient in my current role? Are there tasks where you'd want me to use AI assistance?"
3. **Career Development:** "How are other team members using AI for BD work? Can we share prompts and best practices?"

Completion Criteria

To complete this module:

- ☐ Read all lesson content (approximately 30-45 minutes)
- ☐ Test at least 4 prompts across different categories
- ☐ Create a Personal AI Prompt Library with 5+ prompts

- [] Document lessons learned and refinements
- [] Review the Knowledge Check questions (self-assessment)
- [] Participate in manager discussion (or document self-reflection)

Estimated Total Time: 2-2.5 hours

Additional Resources

AI Tools

ChatGPT	chat.openai.com	Most widely used
Claude	claude.ai	Strong with long docs
Gemini	gemini.google.com	Google integration
Copilot	copilot.microsoft.com	Microsoft integration

Key Terms

LLM: Large Language Model - the AI technology

Prompt: Instructions you give to AI

Token: Unit of text AI processes

Hallucination: When AI generates false information confidently

Context window: How much text AI can consider at once

Quick Reference: GovCon AI Prompts

Research:

Summarize [AGENCY] mission, priorities, and procurement patterns.
I'll verify against official sources.

Opportunity:

Analyze this SAM.gov opportunity and assess fit for a company providing [SERVICES]: [PASTE OPPORTUNITY]

Competitive:

Develop 3 win themes for [OPPORTUNITY] that differentiate us based on [OUR STRENGTHS] versus likely competitors.

Proposal:

Extract all Section L requirements from this RFP as a compliance checklist: [PASTE SECTION L]

Improvement:

Improve this proposal section to be more specific, add proof points, and strengthen the value proposition: [PASTE DRAFT]